

The Late-Diagnosed Adult ADHD Workbook - Printable Worksheets

Every worksheet from the book, one per page. Print as many copies as you need.

The Daily Planning Ritual (five minutes, same time every day)

1. Open the calendar. Read today and tomorrow out loud. Anything to prepare for tomorrow? Add it to the list.
2. Open the list. Add anything in your head. Cross off anything done.
3. Write today's three on the card. If one is large, write its first step.
4. Put the card where you will see it. Close everything else.

When: _____ **Where the card goes:** _____

Today's three	Estimate x my factor	Done
1.		
2.		
3.		

Worksheet 5.1 - The executive function self-check

For each, rate how much trouble it gives you in a typical week: 0 = none, 1 = a little, 2 = a fair amount, 3 = a lot, 4 = it runs my life.

Executive function	What it looks like when it fails	My rating (0-4)	An example from the last week
Working memory	Forgetting why I came into the room, losing the thread, cannot hold the plan		
Inhibition	Interrupting, impulse buys, saying the thing, the phone		
Task initiation	Cannot start the boring or vague thing		
Sustained attention	Cannot stay with it once the novelty goes		
Time perception	Late, underestimate, deadlines are not real until the night before		
Organisation and planning	Cannot break it down; cannot find things		
Emotional regulation	Feelings arrive fast and large; slow to settle		
Self-monitoring	Do not notice I am off track until it is late		

My three highest: _____

These three tell you where to spend your effort. If task initiation is a 4, Week 3 is your week; if working memory is a 4, Week 1 will change your life; if emotional regulation is a 4, do not skip Week 6.

Worksheet 5.2 - Where it costs me

Rate the impact of ADHD on each area of your life right now (0 = none, 4 = severe), and write the single most expensive thing it does there.

Life area	Impact (0-4)	The most expensive thing it does here
Work or study		
Money and admin		
Home (clutter, housework, food)		
Partner / close relationship		
Children and family		
Friends and social life		
Health (sleep, exercise, appointments, medicines)		
Driving and safety		
How I feel about myself		

Worksheet 5.3 - What ADHD gives me

The same brain that loses the keys also does things other brains do not. Everyone has entries in this table; most late-diagnosed adults have never been asked to fill it in.

Strength	Where it shows up in my life
Hyperfocus on things I care about	
Ideas, connections, creativity	
Energy and enthusiasm	
Good in a crisis	
Humour	
Empathy, noticing what others miss	
Persistence when it matters (I got this far)	
Something else	

Worksheet 5.4 - My three goals for the six weeks

Concrete, observable, and small enough to achieve. Not "be organised"; "pay every bill on time for six weeks". Not "procrastinate less"; "finish the tax return by the end of Week 3".

Goal	How I will know it happened (what I could show someone)	Which week's skill it needs most
1.		
2.		
3.		

My review day and time: _____ The person I will tell: _____

Worksheet 5.5 - Before we start: the baseline

Answer these now, and again after Week 6. The change is the evidence.

	Now	After Week 6
Days in the last week I knew what I was supposed to be doing that day (0-7)		
Times in the last week I lost something for more than ten minutes		
Bills or deadlines missed in the last month		
Tasks avoided for more than a month (count them)		
How I feel about my ability to manage my life (0-10)		
Hours of sleep on a typical night		
How often I was hard on myself for ADHD things in the last week (0 = never, 4 = constantly)		

Worksheet 1.1 - Where my life currently lives

List every place a task, date or reminder is currently kept. Be honest; the point is to see the sprawl.

Place (app, notebook, sticky notes, my head, my partner...)	What lives there	Keep, merge or bin?

My one calendar will be: _____ My one list will be:

Merged and binned on (date): _____

Worksheet 1.2 - The daily planning ritual

Fill this in once; it becomes the card in the printable pack.

When (the same time every day, attached to something you already do, e.g. with the first coffee): _____

Where the card goes: _____

The ritual, in order:

1. Open the calendar. Read today and tomorrow out loud. Anything to prepare for tomorrow? Add it to the list.
2. Open the list. Add anything in your head. Cross off anything done.
3. Write today's three on the card. (If one of them is large, write the *first step* of it; Week 3 explains why.)
4. Put the card where you will see it. Close everything else.

Worksheet 1.3 - Capture practice

For seven days, every time a task or a "must remember" arrives, write it on the list *immediately* and put a tick here. The tick is the point: you are training the reflex.

Day	Ticks (one per captured item)	Things I noticed I nearly kept in my head
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

Weekly review (do this on your review day, every week from now on)

Days I did the ritual (out of 7)	
Did every time-bound thing go in the calendar? What slipped?	
Did the list get used, or did things go back into my head?	
One thing that worked	
One thing to change next week	

Worksheet 2.1 - The A/B/C pass

Take your whole list and rate every item. Then copy the As here, in order, least wanted first.

A tasks (must, today or tomorrow)	Why it is an A (what happens if not)	Estimated time

Number of Bs on the list: _____ Number of Cs: _____ Cs I can delete entirely: _____

Worksheet 2.2 - The time log

For three days, before each task write how long you think it will take; afterwards write how long it took. Include the things you do not count, like the fifteen minutes finding the file.

Task	Estimate	Actual	Difference	What I forgot to count

My estimates are usually off by (multiply by): ____ From now on, multiply every estimate by this before you write it in the calendar.

Worksheet 2.3 - Making time visible

Tick what you have set up, with the date.

- ☐ A clock I can see from where I usually work: _____
- ☐ A visual timer or analogue watch: _____
- ☐ Phone alarms for the start of the things I most often run late for (list them): _____
- ☐ Every deadline in the calendar entered as the day before: _____
- ☐ A "leaving the house" alarm 15 minutes before I actually have to leave: _____

Worksheet 2.4 - The blocked day

Plan tomorrow in three blocks. Put your three tasks in, with the multiplied estimate, and leave at least one block with space in it; the space is where the unexpected goes, and there is always something unexpected.

Block	Task(s) from today's three	Estimate x my factor	Done?
Morning			
Afternoon			
Evening			

Weekly review

Days I did the ritual (out of 7)	
Did the As get done before the Bs? Where did the interesting thing win instead?	
My time-estimate factor	
Which of the time-visibility tools I actually used	
One thing that worked	
One thing to change next week	

Worksheet 3.1 - Breaking a task down

Pick the A task you least want to do. Break it into steps until the first one is a physical action of under ten minutes.

The task: _____

Step	Physical action (starts with a verb, ends with something you can see)	Minutes (x your factor)	Done
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

The first step, written on today's card as:

Worksheet 3.2 - The five-minute rule log

Every time you use the five-minute rule this week, record it. You are collecting evidence about yourself.

Task / first step	Started?	Stopped at 5 min or kept going?	How long in the end	How bad was it really (0-10) vs how bad I expected (0-10)

What I notice about expected vs actual:

Worksheet 3.3 - The avoided task audit

The two or three things that have been on the list longest.

The avoided task	How long it has been avoided	What I am actually afraid of / what makes it unpleasant	The first ten-minute step	Novelty / urgency / accountability I will add	Date and time I will do the first step

Worksheet 3.4 - Designing the setting

For the kind of work you avoid most (admin, writing, phone calls, housework, study), design the setting once and reuse it.

	My design
Where (room, cafe, library, kitchen table)	
When (time of day I have the most fuel; after medication if you take it)	
Body double (who, in person or online; a regular slot?)	
Timer (length of sprint; what happens when it rings)	
Phone (in another room / on Do Not Disturb / in a drawer)	
Reward after (the interesting thing, scheduled)	

Weekly review

Days I did the ritual (out of 7)	
Five-minute rule: how many starts, how many kept going	
The avoided tasks: which one moved, and how it felt	
Which setting changes actually helped (body double, room, timer)	
One thing that worked	
One thing to change next week	

Worksheet 4.1 - The distractibility delay

Use this during sprints for a week. At the end of each sprint, tick the ones that still matter.

Sprint (date/time)	Thoughts and urges captured (three words each)	Still matters after the sprint?

What proportion still mattered: _____ What that tells me: _____

Worksheet 4.2 - Finding my sprint length

Try three lengths over the week. Rate how well each went.

Sprint length	Times tried	Finished the sprint on task (out of tries)	How I felt at the end	Keep?
15 min				
20 min				
25 min				
30 min				

My sprint length: _____ My break: _____

Worksheet 4.3 - The environment audit

Rate each from where you most often work.

	Now (0 = terrible, 5 = ideal)	Change I will make	Done on
Phone location during work			
Notifications			
Open windows / documents			
Noise			
Desk / table surface			
People interrupting			
Where I sit (facing a wall vs a window vs a door)			

Worksheet 4.4 - Interrupting hyperfocus

Where I most often lose hours	The alarm I will set (time, wording)	The rule when it rings

Weekly review

Days I did the ritual (out of 7)	
Sprints completed this week	
Distractibility delay: did the urges fade once written?	
The environment change that made the most difference	
One thing that worked	
One thing to change next week	

Worksheet 5.1 - The launch pad and the lost things

Thing I most often lose	Where it ends up	Its home from now on	Set up on
Keys			
Phone			
Wallet / purse			
Glasses			

My launch pad is: _____

Worksheet 5.2 - The paper system

	My decision
The one in-tray (what and where)	
The weekly admin slot (day, time, length, in the calendar?)	
Body double or timer for the slot	
My file headings (aim for 6 to 8)	
Bills to put on direct debit / autopay this week	
Where the unopened backlog goes until the first slot (one box, not five)	

Worksheet 5.3 - The daily reset log

One surface, fifteen minutes, a timer. Tick each day.

Day	Surface	Done (15 min)?	Things that needed a new home
Mon			
Tue			
Wed			
Thu			
Fri			
Sat			
Sun			

Worksheet 5.4 - Money admin (do this in your first admin slot)

Regular bills and their dates (write them all here, then in the calendar)	
Which are already automatic	
Which I will make automatic this week	
Subscriptions I forgot I had (check the bank statement)	
The one money task I have been avoiding, and its first ten-minute step	

Weekly review

Days I did the ritual (out of 7)	
Days I used the launch pad / things lost this week	
Did the admin slot happen? What was in the tray?	
Surfaces reset	
One thing that worked	
One thing to change next week	

Worksheet 6.1 - The thought record

Fill in one a day this week, for the moment the voice was loudest.

Situation	Automatic thought (and % belief)	Feeling (and 0-10)	Evidence for	Evidence against	More accurate thought (and % belief now)	Feeling now (0-10)

Worksheet 6.2 - My usual distortions

Tick the ones that appear most in your records, and write the answer you will use.

Distortion	How often it shows up	My standard answer to it
All-or-nothing		
Mind-reading		
Fortune-telling		
Should statements		
Discounting the positive		
Catastrophising		

Worksheet 6.3 - The rejection plan

The situations that set it off	
What it feels like in the body (so I can recognise it early)	
My delay rule (how long before I reply, decide or act)	
The physical tool I will use in the first five minutes	
The question I will ask myself when the wave has passed	
The person I can check the evidence with	

Worksheet 6.4 - Sleep

	Now	This week's change
Getting-up time (every day)		
Bedtime (roughly)		
Phone at night (where it charges)		
Screens off by		
Daylight in the first hour		
Caffeine after 2 p.m.		
Exercise (when)		

Weekly review - and the six-week review

Days I did the ritual (out of 7)	
Thought records done; the distortion that came up most	
Rejection plan: used? What happened?	
Sleep: getting-up time kept (days out of 7)	
Six weeks: the three changes that made the most difference	
The two I dropped and want to pick back up	
What I would tell myself on Day 1	

Worksheet 9.1 - The two columns

What ADHD cost me (be honest)	What I did anyway / what is possible now

The six-week tracker

Tick each day the ritual happened. That is the only daily measure that matters.

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Review done?
Week 1 - Foundations								
Week 2 - Priorities and time								
Week 3 - Procrastination								
Week 4 - Distraction								
Week 5 - Organisation								
Week 6 - Thinking and feelings								
Week 7								
Week 8								
Week 9								
Week 10								
Week 11								
Week 12								

Blank weekly review

Week of	
Days I did the ritual (out of 7)	
As done before Bs?	
Sprints completed	
Admin slot happened?	
Surfaces reset	
Thought records done	
Sleep: getting-up time kept	
One thing that worked	
One thing to change next week	

Blank task breakdown

The task: _____

Step	Physical action	Minutes (x factor)	Done
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

Blank thought record

Situation	Automatic thought (% belief)	Feeling (0-10)	Evidence for	Evidence against	More accurate thought (% belief)	Feeling now

Print more copies of every worksheet from the link at the front of the book.